

Lab 2 - Career Research

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Part 1 - Job Research

Job	Most Appealing	Most Challenging
Cyber Security Analyst, AWS Security	The most appealing aspect of this job would be how Amazon AWS services are used across many companies, making it applicable if I choose to work in another company. It also provides good career options and a strong foot in the door for growing my career.	Most challenging aspect would be the competition in applying for the role. Alongside this, Amazon infrastructure can be complicated and would be quite the learning curve to understand before developing it.
Cyber Security Analysis, SE Labs	Working for an actual cybersecurity testing company is very appealing since it would allow me to be more involved in my passion for cybersecurity.	Most challenging aspect would be working with Linux. Although I have experience with Ubuntu, it is not as advanced compared to my knowledge using MacOS or Windows.
Cyber Security - Nuclear Graduates 2026	The most appealing part of this job is that I will be gaining a lot of experience during two years of training. Since I will be working in a programme, it would support me in securing roles once I have completed my training.	Similarly to Amazon, applying for a role like this is competitive. Aside from this, understanding nuclear infrastructure, especially physics, is definitely a topic that I would have to revisit.

Part 2 - Skills to Develop

Linux - Practical way to strengthen would be to use Linux operating systems and gain familiarity with shell commands.

Programming - Completing small coding challenges in C++ and Python.

Cloud Technologies - Hands-on cloud experience with major platforms like AWS and Azure, including security configurations, is essential for translating theoretical cybersecurity knowledge into practical skills needed for modern defence.

Unique Strengths

One of my key strengths is my exceptional ability to organise and plan tasks efficiently. I excel at structuring work in an orderly and efficient manner. This strength, combined with my experience working in a security operation centre, will be crucial in the field of cybersecurity, where thoughtful planning is just as critical as precise execution when responding to incidents and safeguarding essential network systems.

Part 3 - Readiness for Chosen Roles

I believe I am on the right path for entry-level cybersecurity roles, particularly those focused on security analysis and operations. My combination of organisational strength, relevant experience, and eagerness to

learn makes me a promising candidate. I should now focus on enhancing my technical skills in Python, Linux, and security frameworks in order to become highly competitive for entry level roles.

How University Can Bridge These Gaps

University bridges the gaps of learning since it teaches a lot of theory that will later apply in our careers. It is our job to seek out the relevant experience to grow in our desired industry. However, university and extracurricular activities, depending on how effectively you utilise these resources, can be a huge help during your employment process since major projects can be a huge talking point during interviews.

An important addition to the university curriculum should be a focus on problem-solving, encouraging students to examine real-world challenges from multiple perspectives and develop innovative ideas rather than relying solely on textbook solutions. This approach would help strengthen critical thinking skills and better prepare students to navigate the rapidly advancing world of technology.

Part 4 - Summary and Reflections

After researching various career paths, I have learned that I am most interested in going into security, specifically security engineering and the software development side of cybersecurity. The jobs I researched highlighted that skills such as Linux, cloud platforms, network monitoring, and version control are consistently valued across roles. I plan to develop these areas through hands-on practice, certifications, and making the most of university projects to build a strong foundation for entry-level cybersecurity positions.